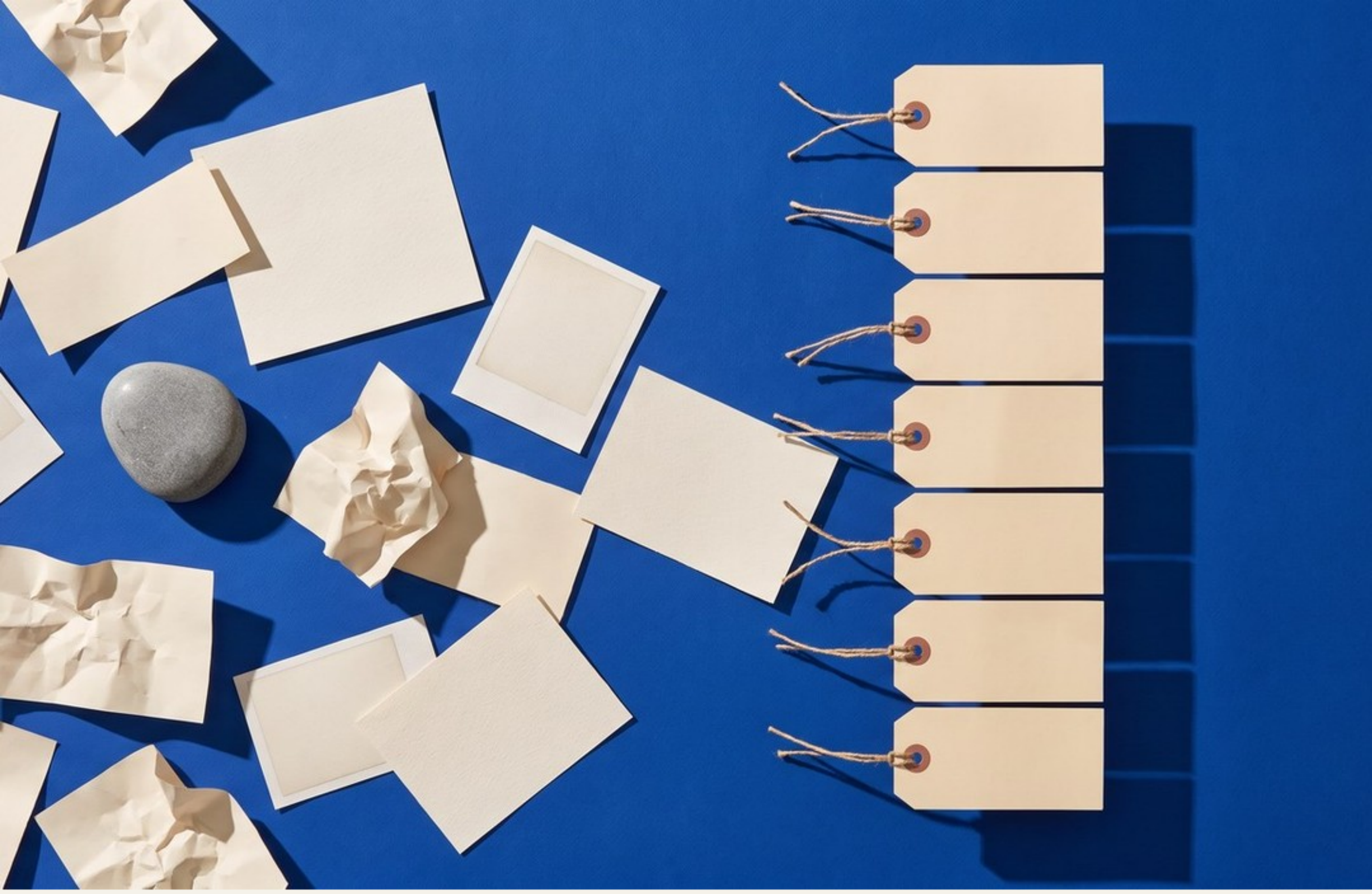


MOTOWN SOLUTIONS

Signs your business has outgrown its spreadsheets

SWIPE

The same status lives in three places

An auction house we built for kept inventory in spreadsheets, a photo folder and a group chat. Over time the three stopped agreeing.

Nobody can say who changed it, or when

A spreadsheet shows where an item is. It can't show who moved it or when, so a disagreement has nothing to settle it.

Deleting the wrong row means it’s gone

One mistake the week before a sale, and someone has to rebuild the record from memory.

Real work happens in a chat thread

Decisions made in the group chat never make it back into any record.

What we built instead

One record per item through seven stages, from intake to sold. Every change is recorded against a person, and deletes can be undone.

AI drafts, a person approves

Photos go in and catalog copy comes out. A cataloger reads and approves every draft before it reaches the inventory.

Read the full write-up

motowntech.com/blog/auction-house-spreadsheets

LINK IN THE COMMENTS